



Customer Experience

Customer Experience at GitLab

The Customer Experience department is part of the [GitLab Sales](#) function who partners with our customers to deliver value and positive business outcomes throughout their journey with GitLab.

The team can be reached in [Slack channel](#) (internal only).

Mission Statement

To deliver value to all customers by engaging in a consistent, repeatable, and scalable way across defined segments so that customers see the value in their investment with GitLab, and we retain and drive growth within our enterprise customers.

The mission of the Customer Experience Department is to provide these customers with experience in order to:

- Accelerate initial customer value
- Maximize long-term, sustainable customer value
- Improve overall customer satisfaction & referenceability
- Maximize the total value of the customer to GitLab

North Star Metrics

Our top-level metrics are:

1. Renewal Rate of ATR (available to renew)
2. Growth ARR
3. Customer Outcomes Realized

Customer Experience Teams

- [Customer Success Manager handbook](#)
- [Customer Success Engineer handbook](#)

- [Customer Success Architect handbook](#)
- [Renewals Managers handbook](#)

Digital Strategy

- [Digital Strategy handbook](#)

Demo Systems

- [Demo Systems documentation](#)

Customer Success Decision Tree

[CSMAE Decision Tree](#) - internal only

Account Team

The account team is comprised of the Strategic Account Executive/Account Executive, Solutions Architect (Enterprise), and Customer Success Manager.

[More information about the account team](#)

Overlap Between Solution Architects and Customer Success Managers or Architects

SA owns 1) pre-sales technical evaluation and relationships prior to the initial sale and 2) tier upgrades and new business units (i.e., connected new) within an existing customer. CSM owns 1) post-sales customer relationship and 2) license upgrades within an existing customer.

[More information on the transition and ownership between Pre-Sales and Post-Sales](#)

Other Resources

Education and Enablement

As a Customer Experience team member, it is important to be continuously learning more about our product and related industry topics. The [education and enablement handbook page](#) provides a dashboard of aggregated resources that we encourage you to use to get up to speed.

GitLab University

Visit the [GitLab University handbook page](#) for an overview of our public-facing learning platform.

Customer Experience Playbooks

See the [Playbooks Page](#)

Customer Workshops

CSM-Created, Enablement Focus:

- [All CSM-created workshops](#)

CSE-Created, Enablement Focus:

- [GitLab User Webinars and Labs](#)

Using Salesforce within Customer Success

Visit [this page](#) for more info on using Salesforce within Customer Success.

Using Gainsight with Customer Success

Visit [this page](#) for more information on using Gainsight within Customer Success.

Using the Customer Feedback Form

Visit [this page](#) for more information on submitting Customer Feedback.

Dogfooding

Outside of Engineering the Customer Experience team has the largest concentration of tooling development capability. The team has unique needs that can't always be solved by GitLab's single [DevOps platform](#). However, it is important to [dogfood](#) and avoid [dogfooding anti-patterns](#). As a result the [Product organization heavily weights internal customers](#) when considering prioritization. If you are considering building tooling in support of Customer Experience priorities outside of GitLab, please follow the [dogfooding process](#).

Customer Experience AWS Test Account

In an effort to keep AWS spend down, initiatives are being taken to automatically clean up our AWS account. This account is primarily used as a proof of concept for IaC and creating demos for GitLab customers. An automated cleanup script is currently being tested that will tag, shutdown and delete old resources as they are no longer needed. The automation will:

- Turn off and Tag Un-named resources. When resources are created a “Name” tag should be created with a value that’s meaningful and indicates who deployed the resource. Example: {initials}-GitLabRunner
- New Resources will be automatically tagged with a Discovered and Expiration tag
- The Expiration tag is 14 days after the discovery. The script will only tag an instance once. If you need additional time, please change the date to a reasonable date for cleanup (Add a month or two for prospective customers)
- If a resource needs to be permanent please set termination protection on the instance. This should also include tagging the instance with an explanation on why it’s permanent and what its for
- On expiration the resource will be shut off and left for 7 days
- In 7 days if the instance is still off a snapshot will be taken and it will be terminated
- If the instance is still on but the expiration has not been changed it will be terminated

Customer Experience Tools and Scripts

By customer or internal request, we sometimes develop tools to automate certain GitLab tasks using the API. The resulting tools and scripts are publicly available for everyone to use and contribute to in the [GitLab CS Tools group](#). **Note:** Those tools are not supported by GitLab Support.

Communities of Practice

[Community of Practice](#) are cross-functional groups of SME’s (or aspiring to be!) within the CX organization dedicated to a topic within GitLab or the broader DevOps space. The goal is to build assets, best practices, demonstrations, and share experiences we learn from prospects and customers. In turn, CoP will build broader technical depth within our CX organization to better advise our customers and influence our product roadmap.

Customer Terrain Mapping Engagements

Terrain Mapping discovery engagements provide customers with the benefit of GitLab’s experience with DevOps methodologies, Git, GitLab, CI, CD, and monitoring by

brainstorming a high level, first draft discovery of the elements of a success plan to address various challenges. They are also mapped to professional services that can help with some of the elements identified in the engagement.

See the [Terrain Mapping Engagements Page](#)

Frequently Asked Questions

Customer Experience team members maintain a [FAQ](#) to keep questions customers ask documented in a place where everyone can view and contribute to.

Customer Experience resource links outside handbook

- [Customer Reference Sheet](#)
- [Sales Collateral](#)
- [GitLab University](#)
- [Our Support Handbook](#)
- [Customer Collaboration Project template](#)
- [GitLab Demo Portal](#)
- [Workflow SA Demo Scenarios](#) (Internal Only)
- [SA-Created - Hands-On Workshops](#)

Other Sales Topics

- [Sales Handbook](#)
- [Sales Operations](#)
- [Sales Skills Best Practices](#)
- [Sales Discovery Questions](#)
- [EE Product Qualification Questions](#)
- [GitLab Positioning](#)
- [FAQ from prospects](#)
- [Client Use Cases](#)
- [Proof of Value Guidelines](#)
- [Account Planning Template for Large/Strategic Accounts](#)
- [Sales Demo](#)
- [Sales Development Group Handbook](#)
- [With Whom to Talk to Ask Questions or Give Feedback on a GitLab feature](#)

Customer Experience Meetings

Customer Experience has a few standing meetings:

- CX Team Monthly All-Hands - Monthly on the second Wednesday
- Technical Skills Exchange (TSX) - Twice Monthly

The different groups within CX also have standing meetings, including meetings for the Customer Success teams and Renewal Managers, regional groups, and social calls.

[**Account Team**](#)

The account team works together to drive value, success, and growth for a customer

[**AI Governance Discovery Question Bank by Industry**](#)

A structured question bank of industry-specific AI governance, risk, and compliance (GRC) discovery questions designed to help organizations identify regulatory, safety, and accountability requirements before deploying AI tools

[**APJ Customer Success**](#)

The APJ Customer Success department is part of the GitLab Sales function under the WW Customer ...

[**Commercial Sales - Customer Success**](#)

The Commercial Sales segment consists of two sales teams, Small Business (SMB) and Mid-Market (MM)

[**CS & SA Roles Overview**](#)

A side-by-side comparison of all customer-facing roles across Customer Success, Solutions Architecture, and Professional Services at GitLab.

[**Customer Health Scoring**](#)

Customer Account Scoring overview and methodology framework to improve our understanding of the customer's journey and their ROI attainment.

[**Customer Success Management Handbook**](#)

The Customer Success Management team at GitLab is a part of the Customer Success department, acting as trusted advisors to our customers and helping them realize value faster.

[**Customer Success Playbooks**](#)

View the Customer Success homepage for additional Customer Success handbook content. Customer ...

[**Customer Success Reporting and Dashboarding framework**](#)

This page describes the underlying philosophy and framework for how to consider and build toward the long term goal of effective and efficient reporting and dashboarding

[**Customer Success Vision**](#)

Create a company-wide customer success approach, providing an engagement framework for the Customer Success organization

[**Customer Success' Frequently Asked Questions**](#)

Customer Success FAQ Charter Team members in Customer Success face questions from customers every ...

[**Customer Terrain Mapping Engagements**](#)

Customer Terrain Mapping Engagements provide customers with the benefit of GitLab's experience ...

[**Customer Workshops**](#)

Please reference the Workshops section on the Customer Success page for up-to-date information on ...

[**DAP Customer Feedback Framework**](#)

DAP Customer Feedback Framework The DAP Customer Feedback platform is GitLab's centralized ...

[**Demo Systems**](#)

The GitLab Demo Systems provide infrastructure for the GitLab Customer Success, Marketing, Sales, and Training teams to demonstrate GitLab features, value propositions, and workflows in a variety of asynchronous and live capacities.

[**Educational Services**](#)

[**GitLab Product Training for Customer Success**](#)

As a Solutions Architect, Customer Success Manager, or Professional Services Engineer, it is important to be continuously learning more about our product and related industry topics. This handbook page provides an dashboard of aggregated resources that we encourage you to use to get up to speed.

[**GitLab Quick Start for New GitLab.com Customers**](#)

Tasks to complete when your subscription starts

[**GitLab Training - Seminar**](#)

GitLab Training - Seminar The GitLab Training - Seminar service is aimed towards organizations who ...

[**GitLab University**](#)

An overview of GitLab University, the free on-demand learning platform for customers, partners, and team members — including what it offers, who owns it at GitLab, and where to get help.

[**Initiatives**](#)

[**Partners**](#)

[**Product Usage Reporting Vision**](#)

The page outlines the current and planned utilization of operational data at GitLab, including Product, Sales, Customer Success, and Marketing.

[**Professional Services Team Handbook**](#)

The Professional Services team at GitLab is a part of the Customer Success department helping customers achieve value faster.

[**Public Sector**](#)

[**Renewals Managers**](#)

[**Resources to get started with GitLab**](#)

A 5-day plan to get started with GitLab

[**Success Tiers**](#)

GitLab's Success Tiers are paid service offerings that provide customers with dedicated ...

[**Transitioning Accounts from Pre-Sales to Post-Sales**](#)

How to effectively transition a customer from the pre-sales engagement to post-sales to ensure the customer is successful.

[**Using Salesforce within Customer Success**](#)

Using Salesforce within Customer Success (Current) Account Onboarding Customer Success Manager ...

Last modified May 8, 2026: [Restructure SA Handbook: Separate Processes, Practices, Playbooks, and Tools \(1fce460c\)](#).

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